

Magic Number Set For Miner Baseball

For the University of Texas at El Paso baseball team, the magic number is two.

No, the Miners aren't that close to the Western Athletic Conference Southern Division title, but this weekend's season-ending series with the University of New Mexico does have enough importance to keep the match interesting.

First of all, Coach Andy Cohen's team enters the Friday-Saturday series with a 24-24 overall won-lost record. The school record for wins in a season is 26, and the Miners need at least two wins to equal that.

More immediately, New Mexico has a one-game edge over the Miners for third place in the WAC-South, UNM has a 3-12 record — all the wins coming off U.T. El Paso in Albuquerque last month — and the Miners are 2-13.

Roy Stringer (6-4), the junior transfer who has a hand in both the U.T. El Paso conference wins, will be the starting pitcher for Cohen in Friday's opener, scheduled for noon at Dudley Field.

Stringer went the distance in a win over Arizona State, and saved a victory over Arizona, the only loss for the Wildcats in WAC play.

New Mexico's probable starter Friday is left-hander Kent Seaman. His record is 3-6, but that includes a 1-0 loss to Arizona and a 4-0 decision to Arizona State in which only one run was earned.

Another southpaw, Ron Adair, (4-4), and right-hander Doug Johnson (4-3) will pitch Saturday's doubleheader.

Jeff Hogan (3-5), and Don Modlinski (3-4) will be the Miner hurlers in the Saturday twinbill set to start at 10 a.m.

Offensively, Glenn Villarreal leads the Miners with a .379 average, while Mike Pettenuzzo, the national leader in triples, is hitting .362.

While the Miners and Lobos are fighting it out for third place in the WAC-South, the two Arizona rivals will be battling for the division title in Tucson. Arizona has a one-game edge over Arizona State currently.